

# THE SOUND OF MUSIC

**Narendra Firodia, Co-founder of You Care Lifestyle, is learning to play an unusual musical instrument**

BY **SMITA TRIPATHI**

**MUSICAL NOTES** Firodia is learning the handpan, a musical instrument that's a cross between the Caribbean Steel Pan and the Indian *Ghatam*

**H**AVE YOU HEARD of the handpan? It's a percussion musical instrument that originated about a decade and a half ago and looks a bit like a UFO. It's a cross between a Caribbean Steel Pan and the Indian *Ghatam* and is made of steel. When Narendra Firodia first heard about the handpan, he was fascinated. "I was struck with the sound the instrument made. It was very soothing," says the 45-year-old Co-founder of You Care Lifestyle, an e-commerce platform for organic food and lifestyle products. So awestruck was he that he decided to learn to play it.

"We had an event for the 75<sup>th</sup> birth anniversary of my father and we wanted to conduct a musical programme. Someone sent me videos of Daniel Waples playing the handpan. That's the first I heard of the instrument," says Firodia. Waples is an international artist who has been playing the handpan for nearly a decade now.

Hearing Waples live inspired Firodia and he began his search for a handpan. After much research he found a manufacturer in Mysore, and it took over two months for the instrument to be prepared since it is completely handcrafted. "Incidentally, that's when the lockdown happened. There was nothing to do and I found some



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